

(3) Job satisfaction - The entrepreneurial, adventuresome, risk-taking mentality is very much alive in America. It largely flourishes thanks to the many small business persons who daily risk everything to market a new product or develop a new invention. More and more people find that running their own business gives them greater satisfaction and more varied experience than working for either a large, impersonal government or corporate bureaucracy.

(4) Lower inflation - Small business, of course, leads to a more competitive economy. Competition means lower prices for the consumer, and a lower inflation rate for the nation as a whole.

(5) Greater freedom - Our political leaders since the founding of the Republic have warned us, above all, against trends which lead to a greater concentration of economic or political power.

The flourishing of small businesses means not only greater economic diversity, but greater political freedom as well.

Despite the importance of small business to the American economy and millions of entrepreneurs, there are ominous signs on the small business horizon.

One is our general economic slowdown. Due to the aging of our manufacturing base, and the new resource constraints, we have entered a difficult economic period. Our economy today is characterized by debilitating uncertainty, a decline in savings,

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